Annotated edition — v0.3.7. The complete v0.01 Alpha source with commentary embedded in the listing — context anchored to the lines it explains, not siloed in a separate appendix.

On January 3, 2009, Satoshi Nakamoto launched Bitcoin with a single executable and these 20,000 lines of C++.

This volume walks that first public release file by file. Explanations appear inline: annotation blocks break the code flow where they belong, so you read the original source and the commentary as one continuous thread — data structures, algorithms, and design choices spelled out without leaving the program in front of you.

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V0.01 ALPHA

ANNOTATED EDITION — V0.3.7

rc/ (Resources)	65
base58.h	69
bignum.h	79
db.cpp	93
db.h	109
headers.h	123
irc.cpp	131
irc.h	143
key.h	147
license.txt	157
main.cpp	165
main.h	219
makefile	247
makefile.vc	253
market.cpp	259
market.h	269
net.cpp	277
net.h	299
readme.txt	321
script.cpp	329
script.h	355
serialize.h	371
sha.cpp	395
sha.h	411
ui.cpp	421
ui.h	467
ui.rc	477
uibase.cpp	483
uibase.h	515
uint256.h	529
uiproject.fbp	549
util.cpp	613
util.h	625

Annotations by Claude Sonnet 4.6 (Revised by Opus 4.6, GPT 5.6 Sol, Grok 4.5, Kimi K3, Opus 5.5)

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